

OPERATIONAL GOVERNANCE STACK ASSESSMENT MODEL (OGSAM) v1

Measuring Governance Capability Across the Five Layers of Operational Governance



LAYER & PURPOSE	ASSESSMENT AREAS	ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS (Score 1-5)	GOVERNANCE QUESTION	OUTCOME
LAYER 5 GOVERNANCE OVERSIGHT LAYER Strategy, oversight, and assurance at the highest organizational level.	- Governance Strategy - Governance Objectives - Risk Appetite - Governance Reporting - Board Oversight - Governance Metrics	- Are governance objectives defined? - Is governance strategy documented? - Is risk appetite established? - Are governance metrics reported? - Does leadership receive governance reporting?	Are AI systems operating within organizational objectives, risk appetite, and governance expectations?	Strategic oversight and assurance.
LAYER 4 ACCOUNTABILITY LAYER Ownership, authority, and accountability for decisions and outcomes.	- Ownership - Decision Rights - Authority Structures - RACI Models - Escalation Paths - Accountability Mechanisms	- Is ownership clearly assigned? - Are decision rights documented? - Are responsibilities defined? - Are escalation paths established? - Is accountability measurable?	Who owns the AI system, its decisions, outcomes, and failures?	Clear accountability and authority.
LAYER 3 CONTROL LAYER Policies, guardrails, and controls that translate governance expectations into enforceable mechanisms.	- Policies - Operational Controls - Guardrails - Access Controls - Data Governance - Model Governance	- Are governance controls defined? - Are controls operationalized? - Are guardrails implemented? - Are access controls enforced? - Are model governance controls operating?	How are governance expectations translated into enforceable operational controls?	Consistent and enforceable controls.
LAYER 2 RUNTIME GOVERNANCE LAYER Monitoring, intervention, and governance during real-time system operation.	- Runtime Monitoring - Runtime Enforcement - Human Intervention - Escalation Mechanisms - Incident Response - Containment & Recovery	- Is runtime monitoring implemented? - Can governance policies be enforced at runtime? - Are human override mechanisms available? - Are incidents detected and escalated? - Are containment procedures established?	How do we monitor, constrain, and intervene while AI systems are actively operating?	Real-time governance and operational resilience.
LAYER 1 EVIDENCE LAYER Logging, audit trails, and evidence to demonstrate and prove governance occurred.	- Logging - Audit Trails - Explainability - Metrics - Reporting - Record Retention	- Are governance activities logged? - Are audit trails complete? - Is traceability maintained? - Are governance KPIs measured? - Are governance reports generated?	How do we prove governance happened?	Verifiable governance evidence.

GOVERNANCE MATURITY SCALE (1-5)					SCORING MODEL (EXAMPLE)			GOVERNANCE HEAT MAP	
1 AD HOC Governance is informal, inconsistent, and dependent on individual effort.	2 DOCUMENTED Governance expectations are documented but not consistently applied.	3 IMPLEMENTED Governance processes are consistently executed and operational.	4 MEASURED Governance effectiveness is measured and performance is managed.	5 OPTIMIZED Governance is embedded, adaptive, and continuously improving.	LAYER	SCORE (1-5)	RATING	LAYER	RATING
					5 Governance Oversight Layer	4.0		5 Governance Oversight Layer	Strong
					4 Accountability Layer	3.5		4 Accountability Layer	Moderate
					3 Control Layer	3.8		3 Control Layer	Moderate
					2 Runtime Governance Layer	2.2		2 Runtime Governance Layer	Weak
					1 Evidence Layer	4.1		1 Evidence Layer	Strong
					OVERALL AVERAGE	3.52	LEVEL 3 IMPLEMENTED		

ASSESSMENT OUTPUTS				
GOVERNANCE MATURITY RATING Overall governance capability score.	GOVERNANCE HEAT MAP Visual representation of strengths and weaknesses.	GOVERNANCE GAP ANALYSIS Identification of capability gaps across layers.	GOVERNANCE IMPROVEMENT ROADMAP Prioritized improvement actions with clear next steps.	EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE SUMMARY Board and leadership reporting package.

GERALD ON GOVERNANCE
PRINCIPLE

Governance maturity is not determined by the existence of policies, committees, or documentation. Governance maturity is determined by the organization's ability to establish oversight, assign accountability, enforce controls, govern at runtime, and produce evidence that governance actually occurred.

Gerald.